

The Core Knowledge[®] Sequence

2023
EDITION

Content and Skill Guidelines for Grades K-8



Language Arts



Science



History and
Geography



Music



Visual Arts



Mathematics

Core Knowledge[®] Sequence

Content and Skill Guidelines for Grades K–8



Core Knowledge[®]



Core Knowledge®

We are pleased that our materials in the Core Knowledge Curriculum Series™, available on our website, are made available through a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International License.



Through the license, the user is free:

- To share: to copy, distribute, and transmit the work
- To remix: to adapt the work

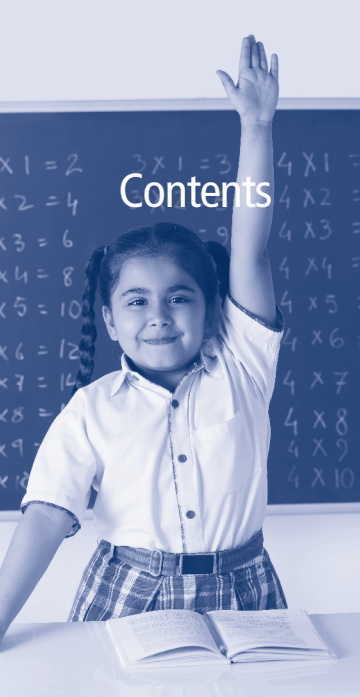
Under the following conditions:

- You must attribute the work in the following manner:

This work is based on an original work of the Core Knowledge® Foundation made available through licensing under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial- ShareAlike 4.0 International License. This does not in any way imply that the Core Knowledge Foundation endorses this work.

- You may not use this work for commercial purposes.
- If you alter, transform, or build upon this work, you may distribute the resulting work only under the same or similar license to this one.

With the understanding that for reuse or distribution, you must make clear to others the license terms of this work. The best way to do that is with a link to this web page: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/>



Contents

Preface

What's New in the 2023 Edition?	ix
What Support is Available for Implementation of Core Knowledge	x

Introduction

What is the <i>Core Knowledge Sequence</i> ?	xi
<i>Core Knowledge Sequence</i> and Standards	xi
The <i>Sequence</i> as the Core of the Curriculum	xi
The Consensus Behind the <i>Core Knowledge Sequence</i>	xi
Equal Access to Knowledge Promotes Excellence and Fairness	xii
The Language of Race: Changes Across Time	xii
The Arts in the Curriculum	xiii
What's New in 2023	xiii
Core Knowledge Schools	xiv
Resources for Teaching the <i>Core Knowledge Sequence</i>	xiv

Preschool

Please flip this publication over to view the *Preschool Sequence*.

Kindergarten

Overview of Topics	2
English Language Arts	3
World History and Geography	12
American History and Geography	13
Visual Arts	15
Music	17
Mathematics	19
Science	21

Grade 1

Overview of Topics	26
English Language Arts	27
World History and Geography	37
American History and Geography	39
Visual Arts	41
Music	43
Mathematics	45
Science	47

Grade 2

Overview of Topics	52
English Language Arts	53
World History and Geography	64
American History and Geography	66
Visual Arts	69

Music	71
Mathematics	73
Science	76
Grade 3	
Overview of Topics	82
English Language Arts	83
World History and Geography	90
American History and Geography	92
Visual Arts	95
Music	97
Mathematics	99
Science	102
Grade 4	
Overview of Topics	108
English Language Arts	110
World History and Geography	117
American History and Geography	120
Visual Arts	124
Music	126
Mathematics	129
Science	133
Grade 5	
Overview of Topics	140
English Language Arts	142
World History and Geography.....	149
American History and Geography	153
Visual Arts	156
Music	158
Mathematics	161
Science	164
Grade 6	
Overview of Topics	172
English Language Arts	174
World History and Geography	183
American History and Geography	187
Visual Arts	189
Music	191
Mathematics	193
Science	196

Grade 7

Overview of Topics	202
English Language Arts	204
History and Geography	213
Visual Arts	229
Music	231
Mathematics	233
Science	236

Grade 8

Overview of Topics	242
English Language Arts	245
History and Geography	255
Visual Arts	306
Music	308
Mathematics	311
Science	314

Appendix A

Why Listening and Learning are Critical to Reading Comprehension	321
--	-----

Appendix B

Using Trade Books to Supplement and Enhance the <i>Core Knowledge Sequence</i>	325
---	-----

Appendix C

Teaching History and Geography in the Middle School Grades	331
--	-----

Appendix D

Knowledge and Social Skills: Powerful Synergy for Productive Citizenship	334
--	-----

Appendix E

Core Knowledge Resources	336
Core Knowledge at a Glance	339

A Letter from the Founder of the Core Knowledge Foundation, E. D. Hirsch, Jr.

Dear Teachers, Parents, Students:

Welcome to the **2023** *Core Knowledge Sequence*!

Warm thanks to all who have contributed to this latest edition of the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, and a warm welcome to those who are using it for the first time.

It works! This current version benefits from the comments of schools over the nation. The *Sequence* builds knowledge coherently and cumulatively.

The mission of the Foundation is and has been to increase the ease of implementing the *Sequence*; thus, the Foundation now offers curriculum that closely follows the *Sequence*. The *Sequence* and resulting curriculum are now used in some 10,000 schools in the United States! It is a firm preparation for anything that even a select high school will throw at you!

It's a proven vehicle for raising and equalizing reading abilities of children from families of every income level. It originates in the following ever-more-validated scientific insight: *that high literacy and excellent education depend on students gaining the background knowledge that is silently taken for granted in serious books and newspapers and websites and that is also taken for granted when we have transactions with other educated Americans.*

Without possessing that broad literate knowledge, doors remain closed. With it, doors, and worlds, and opportunities open wide. We all benefit from a rich elementary education, because possessing that broadly shared literate knowledge is a very good start for being a productive and devoted citizen of the USA. Well educated young Americans can fulfill their potentials and help renew our nation

A heartfelt thank you for all the exemplary schools following the *Sequence* that have been a beacon of excellence leading other schools to follow. Your students and the nation owe you their gratitude.

Sincerely,



E. D. Hirsch, Jr.

Preface to the 2023 Edition of the *Core Knowledge Sequence*

We at the Core Knowledge Foundation fervently believe that our experience over the past thirty years in championing the use of a coherent, cumulative, content-specific curriculum in schools throughout the United States can be of significant value to states and school districts looking to take the next step forward.

To that end, we offer this updated, 2023 edition of the *Core Knowledge Sequence*. Our original mission, Excellence and Equity for All Children, remains unchanged. The simple, yet powerful underlying premise of Core Knowledge, that knowledge builds on knowledge, still fuels our mission. Nearly all of our most important goals for education—greater reading comprehension, the ability to think critically and solve problems, even higher test scores—are a function of the depth and breadth of our knowledge. Although current events and technology are constantly changing, there is a body of lasting knowledge and skills that form the core of a strong Preschool through Grade 8 curriculum. Explicit identification of what children should learn at each grade level ensures a coherent approach to building knowledge across all grade levels, making efficient and effective use of instructional time. Every child should learn the fundamentals of science, basic principles of government, important events in history, essential elements of mathematics, widely acknowledged masterpieces of art and music from around the world, and stories and poems passed down from generation to generation.

Many of the changes made in this latest edition reflect new findings from cognitive research, current standards, and a concerted effort to incorporate *more* inclusive representation of the peoples and cultures that have shaped the world into what we know today.

Over the past thirty years, we have been able to refine and fine tune the implementation of Core Knowledge, thanks to the effort and feedback of thousands of teachers who have put the *Core Knowledge Sequence* into practice in real classrooms with real students. We have attempted to reflect our increased wisdom with regard to effective implementation in this 2023 edition of the *Sequence*.

What's New in the 2023 Edition?

We call your attention specifically to the following revisions.

- **Increased elaboration of the English language arts (ELA) and mathematics sections of the *Sequence***
 - ELA: We updated the ELA skill guidelines to represent our best insights into what effective language arts instruction should encompass—a broader view of “language” within the language arts block; the coherent integration of rich content, i.e., nonfiction, within the language arts block; explicit, systematic instruction in phonics in the early grades (K–3); emphasis on vocabulary, morphology, and grammar in the later grades (3–8); and explicit expectations around writing. These guidelines serve as the framework for our Core Knowledge Language Arts (CKLA) Program. Visit our website (www.coreknowledge.org) for more information.
 - Math: In this update, we narrowed the focus of the math skill guidelines; thus, allowing deeper study around fundamental concepts.¹ As a result, grade levels will explore the following domains:
 - Grades K–2: Concepts, skills, and problem solving related to addition and subtraction
 - Grades 3–5: Concepts, skills, and problem solving related to multiplication and division of whole numbers and fractions

¹ “Key Shifts in Mathematics.” Key Shifts in Mathematics | Common Core State Standards Initiative. Accessed June 4, 2021. <http://www.corestandards.org/other-resources/key-shifts-in-mathematics/>.

- Grade 6: Ratios and proportional relationships, and early algebraic expressions and equations
- Grade 7: Ratios and proportional relationships, and arithmetic of rational numbers
- Grade 8: Linear algebra and linear functions

Educators are encouraged to build conceptual understanding, procedural skills and fluency, and application with equal intensity at each grade.

- **Updated and enhanced science guidelines to reflect the Next Generation Science Standard's (NGSS) emphasis on scientific practice, while developing a foundation of scientific knowledge**
 - Thanks to ongoing research in the field, our understanding of how children learn continues to evolve. In the subject area of science, students benefit from not just reading about concepts and ideas, but from hands-on experiences. The updated *Sequence* incorporates the NGSS emphasis on scientific practice. The NGSS prescribes a multi-dimensional approach to science learning and instruction, integrating core ideas, hands-on practices, and crosscutting concepts, as well as applications of scientific knowledge in engineering and technology. Many of these NGSS principles are reflected in this *Sequence* as well as the characteristic Core Knowledge emphasis on specific content that coherently builds from one grade to the next.
- **Incorporation of contemporary works in literature, art, and music**
 - While Core Knowledge will always offer students access to classical pieces that informed and shaped American culture, we recognize that the inclusion of a selection of contemporary works will provide a connection to the current world. Therefore, this updated *Core Knowledge Sequence* presents both classic and modern works with timeless themes and enduring appeal. Our goal is to offer students a sense of the diversity and richness of literature, art, and music throughout the ages.
- **Offering a renewed commitment to represent the diverse peoples and cultures of the past and present, who enriched our society**
 - Highlighting diverse cultural contributions across subjects and grades in the *Sequence* not only offers students the opportunity to see themselves in the curriculum, it also builds tolerance and appreciation of people different from themselves. Being fully prepared to engage and communicate with peers within this country and around the world requires a detailed, rich knowledge of the ways in which different civilizations have enriched each other across time. The updated *Sequence* reflects an effort to include more voices in America's story and the development of today's world.

Note: See Appendix D to learn more about the connection between cultural knowledge and productive citizenship.

What Support is Available for Implementation of Core Knowledge?

The Core Knowledge Foundation is ready and able to assist states, districts, and individual schools who want to join the ranks of those who are successfully implementing Core Knowledge. The Core Knowledge website (www.coreknowledge.org) offers a wealth of information on how to get started, accessing support materials, professional learning opportunities, as well as many free online resources. Be sure to check out the *Download Curriculum* webpage (www.coreknowledge.org/curriculum/download-curriculum) to access digital copies of our Core Knowledge Curriculum Series™ materials!

Please do not hesitate to contact us directly by phone (434-977-7550) or online: (www.coreknowledge.org/contact-us/).

Introduction

What is the *Core Knowledge Sequence*?

The *Core Knowledge Sequence* is a detailed outline of specific content and skills to be taught in language arts, history, geography, mathematics, science, and the fine arts. As the core of a school's curriculum, it is intended to provide a coherent, content specific foundation of learning, while allowing flexibility to meet local needs.

The *Sequence* represents an effort to describe and state the specific core of shared knowledge that all children should learn in U.S. schools, and that speakers and writers assume their audience knows. It should be emphasized that the *Core Knowledge Sequence* is not a list of facts to be memorized. Rather, it is a guide to coherent content from grade to grade, designed to encourage cumulative academic progress as children build their knowledge and skills from one year to the next.

Core Knowledge Sequence and Standards

"Students will comprehend, evaluate, and respond to works of literature and other kinds of writing which reflect their own cultures and developing viewpoints as well as those of others, using prior knowledge to extend reading ability and comprehension."

This language arts standard is fairly typical of many performance standards. It is broad enough that disagreement is difficult—students *should* be able to comprehend, evaluate and respond to works of literature—but offers little help to teachers in planning units and lessons.

Standards typically describe what students should be able to do, but not what students should know. The content-rich, thoughtfully designed *Core Knowledge Sequence* complements state standards by offering a concrete blueprint to guide teaching and learning. Instead of spending hours researching and planning what to teach, teachers are freed to think more creatively about how to teach. They know what children have learned in previous grades and what they will need in succeeding grades. They can avoid useless repetition. They are less likely to be confronted by big gaps in what students have learned.

The *Sequence* as the Core of the Curriculum

The *Core Knowledge Sequence* offers a blueprint for content and skills instruction. As a means of supporting daily implementation, the Core Knowledge Curriculum Series™ provides comprehensive materials that can be used to teach the content and skills identified in the *Core Knowledge Sequence* in a coherent, cumulative, and cross-curricular way. Current programs include:

- Core Knowledge Language Arts (CKLA)
- Core Knowledge History and Geography (CKHG)
- Core Knowledge Science (CKSci)
- Core Knowledge Math (CKMath)

New instructional materials are under development for computer science, civics, and economics. To receive announcements as new materials are released, please complete the "Stay in the Know" form at the bottom of the Core Knowledge Foundation home page (<https://www.coreknowledge.org/>).

For more information see Appendix E, *Core Knowledge Grade-by-Grade Resource Recommendations*, or visit the Core Knowledge Foundation website (www.coreknowledge.org/curriculum).

The Consensus Behind the *Core Knowledge Sequence*

The *Core Knowledge Sequence* is the result of a lengthy and rigorous process of research and consensus-building undertaken by the Core Knowledge Foundation, an independent, nonpartisan, nonprofit organization dedicated to excellence and fairness in early education.

To achieve a consensus on the topics to be included in the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, in 1986, the Foundation first analyzed the many reports issued by state departments of education and by professional organizations, such as the National Council of Teachers of Mathematics and the American Association for the Advancement of Science, which recommend general outcomes for elementary and secondary education. We also examined the knowledge and skills specified in the successful educational systems of several other countries, including France, Japan, Sweden, and Germany.

In addition, we formed an advisory board on multiculturalism that proposed the inclusion of diverse cultural traditions that American children should all share as part of their school-based common culture. We sent the resulting materials to three independent groups of teachers, scholars, and scientists around the country, asking them to create a master list of the core knowledge children should have learned by the end of Grade 6. About 150 teachers, including college professors, scientists, and administrators, were involved in this initial step.

These items were combined into a draft *Sequence*, and additional groups of teachers and specialists were asked to agree on a grade-by-grade sequence of the items. That draft sequence was then sent to some one hundred educators and specialists who participated in a national conference that was called to hammer out a working agreement on core knowledge for the first six grades; kindergarten, grades 7 and 8, and preschool were subsequently added to the *Sequence*.

This important meeting took place in March 1990. The conferees were elementary school teachers, curriculum specialists, scientists, science writers, officers of national organizations, representatives of ethnic groups, district superintendents, and school principals from across the country. A total of twenty-four working groups decided on revisions to the draft *Sequence*. The resulting provisional *Core Knowledge Sequence* was fine-tuned during a year of implementation at a pioneering school, Three Oaks Elementary in Lee County, Florida. Also, the Visual Arts and Music sections of the *Sequence* were further developed based on the research of the Core Knowledge Foundation, with the assistance of advisors and teachers.

An Ongoing Process

Because the *Sequence* is intended to be a living document that provides a foundation of knowledge that speakers and writers assume their audiences know, it has been—and will continue to be—periodically updated and revised. Each new edition involves key stakeholders, and a careful review of both national standards and current trends in cognitive science. The 2023 edition reflects a multi-year effort that engaged subject matter experts, educator focus groups, and the Core Knowledge community network.

Equal Access to Knowledge Promotes Excellence and Fairness

Only by specifying the knowledge that all children should share can we guarantee equal access to that knowledge. In our current system, schools often do not hold high expectations for all students, particularly children from low income families. In many cases, this translates into watered-down curricula. Conversely, schools that implement curricula based on the *Core Knowledge Sequence* expose all children to coherent, core content that commands rigor. This not only provides a foundation for later learning, but also makes up the common ground for communication in our diverse society.

All of the most successful educational systems in the world teach a core of knowledge in the early grades. As both research and common sense demonstrate, we learn new knowledge by building on what we already know. It is important to begin building foundations of knowledge in the early grades because that is when children are most receptive, and because academic deficiencies in the first eight grades can permanently impair the quality of later schooling.

The Language of Race: Changes Across Time

It has been our goal to remain culturally sensitive to generally accepted current usage when writing of race and ethnicity in our publications. However, not all major publishing organizations always agree on the specific standards to follow when referring to race and ethnicity in writing. In cases where there is no universal agreement, we have had to choose which standards to follow, such as:

- Currently, major publications do not agree on the use of hyphens in terms that describe a person's dual heritage—some say, for instance, “Mexican-American” while others say “Mexican American.” In Core Knowledge publications, we have chosen not to use the hyphen.
- There is ongoing debate regarding the use of “Latinos” to refer to people of Spanish heritage as a whole. Since “Latino” is a masculine form, and “Latina” the feminine, some have urged the use of a new gender-neutral term, “Latinx” (pronounced *la-TEEN-ex*). In Core Knowledge publications, we continue to follow the practice of the U.S. Census Bureau, which refers to people of “Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish” origin.
- There is continuing discussion about whether to use the lowercase “black” or uppercase “Black” to refer to persons of African ancestry. In keeping with the practice of an increasing number of major publications, in Core Knowledge publications, we use the uppercase “Black,” which acknowledges, as an editor for the *New York Times* explains, “the difference between a color and a culture.”
- While we have chosen to capitalize “Black,” we have chosen not to capitalize “white.” Some publications have begun to capitalize “white”—see, for example, the guidelines of National Association of Black Journalists or the American Psychological Association. There are arguments for capitalizing “white” on the grounds that lowercase “white” might be taken to imply “whiteness” as a commonly accepted norm apart from race, while uppercase “White” acknowledges “Whiteness” as a racial identity in the context of American history. On the other hand, the *New York Times*, the *Columbia Journalism Review*, and others make the point that “white” should remain lowercase because hate groups and white supremacists have long insisted on capitalizing “white.” Given the lack of consensus on this matter, we maintain our practice of not capitalizing “white,” while affirming that “whiteness” is not to be understood as a norm but as a racial identity.

The Arts in the Curriculum

The Core Knowledge Foundation sees the arts not as a peripheral part of the curriculum, but as an essential part of the knowledge all children should learn in the early grades.

Early instruction in the arts should be noncompetitive, and provide many opportunities to sing, dance, listen to music, play act, read and write poetry, draw, paint, and make objects. Equally important, children should be exposed to fine paintings, great music, and other inspiring examples of art. As children progress in their knowledge and competencies, they can begin to learn more about the methods and terminology of the different arts, and become familiar with an ever wider range of great artists and acknowledged masterworks.

Through attaining a basic knowledge of the arts, children are not only better prepared to understand and appreciate works of art, but also to communicate their ideas, feelings, and opinions to others. A good understanding of the arts grows out of at least three modes of knowledge—creative (i.e., directly making artworks), historical, and analytical. Early study of the arts should embrace all three modes with special emphasis on creativity and active participation.

The arts guidelines in the *Core Knowledge Sequence* are organized into two main sections: Visual Arts and Music. While the *Sequence* does not present other arts such as dance or drama as separate disciplines, we acknowledge their importance and have incorporated them in other disciplines (for example, dance is in music; drama, in English language arts).

What's New in 2023

Architecture

While architecture was included in the previous editions of the *Sequence*, in 2023, architectural structures are now studied at every grade level. This offers students the opportunity to observe elements of art in structures as well as learn how the designs of buildings, just like works of art, are often inspired by the period.

Contemporary Works

Contemporary works were previously included in both the visual arts and music sections of the *Sequence*. While the original and new works are all considered a valuable asset in broadening

students' background knowledge, this larger list may require teachers be selective (rather than teach everything) in order to adequately address the work in an academic year. We strongly recommend that schools consult with all interested parties within their community – educators, parents, and subject matter experts – before making these decisions.

Core Knowledge Schools

The Core Knowledge Foundation serves as the hub of a nationwide network of Core Knowledge schools. Core Knowledge schools are dedicated to teaching solid academic content and skills to all children. To implement Core Knowledge, many people involved with the school's operations, including both staff and parents, need to engage in a great deal of thoughtful discussion and collaborative planning. The process of "getting started" typically includes these early steps:

- Building buy-in among stakeholders (staff and larger school community)
- Exploring Core Knowledge curricula (to determine where and how to start implementation)
- Considering how Core Knowledge aligns with standards and other school initiatives

Effective implementation relies on a commitment from school leaders and teachers to the Core Knowledge approach.

For more information on adopting or implementing the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, including professional learning, contact the Core Knowledge Foundation at 434-977-7550 or www.coreknowledge.org/contact-us.

Resources for Teaching the *Core Knowledge Sequence*

Instructional materials, part of the Core Knowledge Curriculum Series™, are available for free download on the Core Knowledge Foundation website (www.coreknowledge.org/download-curriculum/). Prior to selecting and purchasing materials, we encourage you to download and peruse these resources.

For a list of current resources and prices, visit the Core Knowledge website at www.coreknowledge.org/store, or contact us directly at:

Core Knowledge Foundation
801 East High Street
Charlottesville, VA 22902
telephone: (434) 977-7550
fax: (434) 977-0021

contact form: www.coreknowledge.org/contact-us
home page: www.coreknowledge.org

Kindergarten



Overview of Topics

Kindergarten

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

- I. Listening and Speaking
 - A. Classroom Discussion
 - B. Presentation of Ideas and Information
 - C. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—All Texts
 - D. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry
 - E. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Nonfiction and Informational Text
- II. Reading
 - A. Print Awareness
 - B. Phonological and Phonemic Awareness
 - C. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding
 - D. Oral Reading and Fluency
 - E. Reading Comprehension—All Texts
- III. Writing
- IV. Language Conventions
 - A. Handwriting and Spelling
 - B. Parts of Speech and Sentence Structure
 - C. Capitalization and Punctuation
- V. Poetry
 - A. Mother Goose and Other Traditional Poems
 - B. Other Poems, Old and New
- VI. Fiction
 - A. Stories
 - B. Aesop's Fables
 - C. American Folk Heroes and Tall Tales
 - D. Literary Terms
 - E. Sayings and Phrases

HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

WORLD HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. Geography: Spatial Sense
- II. An Overview of the Seven Continents

AMERICAN HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. Geography
- II. Native American Peoples, Past and Present
- III. Early Exploration and Settlement
 - A. The Voyage of Columbus (Cristoforo Colombo) in 1492
 - B. The Pilgrims
 - C. July 4, "Independence Day"
- IV. Presidents, Past and Present
- V. Symbols and Figures

VISUAL ARTS

- I. Elements of Art
 - A. Color
 - B. Line
 - C. Artworks
- II. Sculpture
- III. Architecture

MUSIC

- I. Elements of Music
- II. Listening and Understanding
- III. Songs

MATHEMATICS

- I. Counting and Cardinality
- II. Operations and Algebraic Thinking
- III. Number and Operations in Base Ten
- IV. Measurement and Data
- V. Geometry

SCIENCE

- I. Pushes and Pulls
 - A. Pushes and Pulls are Forces
 - B. Pushes and Pulls can Change an Object's Motion
 - C. Magnetism is a Force
- II. Needs of Plants and Animals
 - A. Plants and Animals
 - B. Plants, Their Needs, and Their Environments
 - C. Animals, Their Needs, and Their Environments
 - D. Humans, Their Needs, and Their Environments
- III. Changing Environments
 - A. Ecosystems
 - B. Plants in Ecosystems
 - C. Animals in Ecosystems
 - D. Human Changes in Ecosystems
 - E. People Design Solutions to Reduce Human Impact
- IV. Weather Patterns
 - A. Sunlight
 - B. Patterns in Weather Conditions
 - C. Severe Weather
- V. The Human Body: Our Five Senses
 - A. Vision and Hearing
 - B. Smell, Taste, and Touch
 - C. Taking Care of Your Body
- VI. Science Biographies

Kindergarten | English Language Arts



The *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts* emphasize the critical importance of building nonfiction background knowledge in a coherent and sequenced way within and across grades. This can be accomplished most effectively, at each grade level, by integrating the topics from history, geography, science, and the arts in the *Core Knowledge Sequence* into the language arts block. Note that in the *Sequence*, there are many cross-curricular connections to history and science topics within Language Arts (e.g., poems, stories, and sayings), as well as to visual arts and music, which can and should be integrated into the applicable domain of study.

NOTE: The objectives listed in sections I–IV of Language Arts below are consistent with the *Core Knowledge Language Arts* program and embed all of the skills and concepts within the *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts*.

I. Listening and Speaking

Teachers: Shortly after a baby is born, an amazingly complex, interactive communication process begins between the infant and others in his/her environment. While it may seem like an obvious statement, it is nonetheless worth making the point that listening and speaking are the primary means of communication throughout the early years of a young child's development. It should be equally obvious that reading and writing competencies are predicated on competencies in listening and speaking. When a child enters kindergarten, however, traditional language arts instruction has typically accorded little, if any, attention to the ongoing development of children's listening and speaking ability. We have acted as if listening and speaking competencies are fully and firmly established and can be left behind as reading and writing instruction begins. Nothing could be further from the truth. This omission in language arts instruction has been a serious oversight. We must remedy this oversight, deliberately elaborating and extending listening and speaking skills, while we simultaneously begin to introduce reading, and then writing. Children who are fortunate enough to participate in language arts instruction that recognizes the importance of continuing to build listening and speaking competency while also beginning reading and writing instruction will, in the end, be far more literate adults.

A. Classroom Discussion

- Participate in age appropriate activities involving listening and speaking.
- Speak clearly with volume appropriate to the setting.
- Use agreed-upon rules for group discussions, i.e., look at and listen to the speaker, raise hand to speak, take turns, say "excuse me" or "please," etc.
- Ask questions to clarify conversations, directions, exercises, and/or classroom routines.
- Carry on and participate in a conversation over four to five turns, staying on topic, initiating comments or responding to a partner's comments, with either an adult or another child of the same age.
- Identify and express physical sensations, mental states, and emotions of self and others.
- Understand and use language to express spatial and temporal relationships (*up, down, first, last, before, after, etc.*).
- Understand and use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions.
- Understand and use common sayings and phrases such as "Better safe than sorry" and "Look before you leap."

B. Presentation of Ideas and Information

- Follow multi-step, oral directions.
- Give simple directions.
- Provide simple explanations.
- Recite a nursery rhyme, poem or song independently.

C. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—All Texts

Teachers: Written text makes use of richer vocabulary and more complex syntax than conversational language. It is important that young children be exposed not only to the language of everyday conversation but also to the richer and more formal language of books. This can be done through frequent reading aloud. Helping young children develop the ability to listen to and understand written texts when they are read aloud must be an integral part of any initiative designed to build literacy.

At the kindergarten level, a students' ability to understand what they hear far outpaces their ability to independently read and understand written text. By listening to stories or nonfiction selections read aloud, students can experience the complexities of written language without expending cognitive energy on decoding; they can likewise access deeper and more complex content knowledge than they are presently able to read independently.

Careful consideration should be given to the selection of books read aloud to ensure that the vocabulary and syntax presented is rich and complex. Leveled texts will not provide the rich language experience desired during read-alouds and should only be used as a starting point with students for whom English is a second language.

Grade appropriate read-aloud selections for poetry and fiction are included in the *Sequence*. Nonfiction read-alouds should be selected on the basis of the history, science, music and visual art topics identified for kindergartners in the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, with emphasis on history and science read-alouds. It is strongly recommended that daily read-alouds focus on a single topic over a sustained period of time—about two weeks—rather than intermingling read-alouds on a variety of subjects. Careful consideration should be given to the order in which nonfiction read-alouds are presented to ensure that knowledge about a topic builds in a progressive and coherent way.

Following any read-aloud, students should participate in rich, structured conversations with an adult in response to the written text that has been read aloud. In this way, they can begin to orally practice comparing, analyzing, and synthesizing ideas in written text in much the same way as they will be expected to do as independent readers in the later grades.

- Listen to and understand a variety of texts read aloud, including fictional stories, fairy tales, fables, historical narratives, drama, informational text, and poems.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Describe illustrations.
- Sequence four to six pictures illustrating events in a read-aloud.
- Answer questions requiring literal recall and understanding of the details and/or facts of a read-aloud, i.e., who, what, where, when, etc.
- Retell key details.
- Ask questions to clarify information in a read-aloud.
- Use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions, a scene or facts in a read-aloud.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Understand and use words and phrases heard in read-alouds.
- Compare and contrast similarities and differences within a single read-aloud or between two or more read-alouds.
- Make personal connections to events or experiences in a read-aloud and/or make connections among several read-alouds.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to listening to a read-aloud, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read aloud.
- Use pictures accompanying the read-aloud to check and support understanding of the read-aloud.
- Make predictions prior to and during a read-aloud, based on the title, pictures, and/or text heard thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.

- Answer questions that require making interpretations, judgments, or giving opinions about what is heard in a read-aloud, including answering “why” questions that require recognizing cause/effect relationships.
- Identify who is telling a story or providing information in a text.

D. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry

- Retell or dramatize a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence.
- Change some story events and provide a different story ending.
- Create and tell an original story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence
- Distinguish fantasy from realistic text in a story.
- Demonstrate understanding of literary language (e.g., author, illustrator, characters, setting, plot, dialogue, personification, simile, and metaphor) and use some of these terms in retelling stories or creating their own stories.

E. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Nonfiction and Informational Text

Teachers: Select nonfiction read-aloud topics from the kindergarten history, science, music, and visual arts topics, with emphasis on history and science.

- Retell important facts and information from a nonfiction read-aloud.
- With assistance, categorize and organize facts and information within a given topic.
- With assistance, create and interpret timelines and lifelines related to read-alouds.
- Distinguish read-alouds that describe events that happened long ago from those that describe contemporary or current events

II. Reading

A. Print Awareness

- Demonstrate understanding that what is said can be written and that the writing system is a way of writing down sounds.
- Demonstrate understanding of directionality (left to right, return sweep, top to bottom, front to back).
- Identify the parts of books and function of each part (front cover, back cover, title page, table of contents).
- Demonstrate correct book orientation by holding book correctly and turning pages.
- Recognize that sentences in print are made up of separate words.
- Understand that words are separated by spaces.
- Distinguish letters, words, sentences, and stories.
- Demonstrate understanding of basic print conventions by tracking and following print word for word when listening to text read aloud.
- Demonstrate understanding that the sequence of letters in a written word represents the sequence of sounds in the spoken word.
- Recognize and name the twenty-six letters of the alphabet in both their upper-case and lower-case forms.
- Say the letters of the alphabet in order, either in song or recitation

B. Phonological and Phonemic Awareness

- Identify environmental sounds, e.g., keys jingling, scissors cutting, clapping.
- Identify whether pairs of environmental sounds are the same or different.
- Count the number of environmental sounds heard, e.g., clapping, rhythm band instruments.

- Orally segment sentences into discrete words.
- Demonstrate understanding that words are made up of sequences of sounds.
- Demonstrate understanding that vowel sounds are produced with the mouth open and airflow unobstructed, whereas consonant sounds involve closing parts of the mouth and blocking the air flow.
- Given a pair of spoken words, select the one that is longer (i.e., contains more phonemes).
- In riddle games, supply words that begin with a target phoneme.
- Indicate whether a target phoneme is or is not present in the initial/medial/final position of a spoken word, e.g., hear /m/ at the beginning of *mat* and /g/ at the end of *bag*.
- Listen to one-syllable words and tell the beginning or ending sounds, e.g., given *dog*, identify initial /d/ or final /g/.
- Recognize the same phoneme in different spoken words, e.g., /b/ in *ball*, *bug*, and *big*.
- Identify whether pairs of phonemes are the same or different, including pairs that differ only in voicing, e.g., /b/ and /p/.
- Orally blend two to three sounds to form a word, e.g., given the sounds /k/.../a/... /t/, blend to make *cat*.
- Segment a spoken word into phonemes, e.g., given *bat*, produce the segments/b//a//t/.
- Given a spoken word, produce another word that rhymes, e.g., given *hit*, supply *bit* or *mitt*.
- Identify the number of syllables in a spoken word

C. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding

Teachers: Learning to read requires understanding and mastering the written English code through explicit and systematic phonics instruction. Research suggests that phonics instruction is most effective when specific letter-sound relationships are taught and reinforced by having students both read and write the letter-sound correspondence being studied. Reading and writing—decoding and encoding—are complementary processes that ensure mastery of the written code.

- Demonstrate understanding that a systematic, predictable relationship exists between written letters (graphemes) and spoken sounds (phonemes).
- Blend individual phonemes to pronounce printed words.
- Understand that sometimes two or more printed letters stand for a single sound.
- Read and write any CVC word, e.g., *sit* or *cat*.
- Read and write one-syllable words containing common initial consonant clusters such as tr-, fl-, dr- and sp- and consonant digraphs such as ch-, sh-, th-, etc.
- Read and write words containing separated vowel graphemes, such as, *late*, *bite*, *note*, *cute*.
- Read tricky spellings that can be sounded two ways, e.g., the letter 's' sounded /s/ as in *cats* and /z/ as in *dogs*.
- Read and write chains of one-syllable words in which one sound is added, substituted, or omitted, e.g., read at > *cat* > *bat* > *bad* > *bid*.
- Read at least 15 words generally identified as very high frequency words..

Consonant Sounds and Spellings Taught in Kindergarten

/b/ spelled 'b' as in *boy*, 'bb' as in *tubby*
 /d/ spelled 'd' as in *dog*, 'dd' as in *madder*
 /f/ spelled 'f' as in *fun*, 'ff' as in *stuff*
 /g/ spelled 'g' as in *get*, 'gg' as in *egg*
 /h/ spelled 'h' as in *him*
 /j/ spelled 'j' as in *jump*

/k/ spelled 'c' as in *cat*, 'k' as in *kitten*, 'ck' as in *sick*, 'cc' as in *moccasin*
 /l/ spelled 'l' as in *lip*, 'll' as in *sell*
 /m/ spelled 'm' as in *mad*, 'mm' as in *hammer*
 /n/ spelled 'n' as in *net*, 'nn' as in *funny*
 /p/ spelled 'p' as in *pet*, 'pp' as in *happy*
 /r/ spelled 'r' as in *red*, 'rr' as in *earring*
 /s/ spelled 's' as in *sit*, 'ss' as in *dress*
 /t/ spelled 't' as in *top*, 'tt' as in *butter*
 /v/ spelled 'v' as in *vet* /w/ spelled 'w' as in *wet*
 /x/ spelled 'x' as in *tax*
 /y/ spelled 'y' as in *yes*
 /z/ spelled 'z' as in *zip*, 'zz' as in *buzz*, 's' as in *dogs*
 /ch/ spelled 'ch' as in *chop*
 /sh/ spelled 'sh' as in *ship*
 /th/ spelled 'th' as in *thin*
 /th/ spelled 'th' as in *then*
 /qu/ spelled 'qu' as in *quick*
 /ng/ spelled 'ng' as in *sing*, 'n' as in *pink*

Vowel Sounds and Spellings Taught in Kindergarten

/a/ spelled 'a' as in *cat*
 /e/ spelled 'e' as in *get*
 /i/ spelled 'i' as in *hit*
 /o/ spelled 'o' as in *hot*
 /u/ spelled 'u' as in *but*
 /ae/ spelled 'a_e' as in *cake*
 /ee/ spelled 'ee' as in *bee*
 /ie/ spelled 'i_e' as in *bike*
 /oe/ spelled 'o_e' as in *note*
 /ue/ spelled 'u_e' as in *cute*
 /er/ spelled 'er' as in *her*
 /ar/ spelled 'ar' as in *car*
 /or/ spelled 'or' as in *for*

D. Oral Reading and Fluency

- Read decodable stories that incorporate the specific code knowledge that has been taught.
- Use phonics skills in conjunction with context to confirm or self-correct word recognition and understanding, rereading as necessary.
- Demonstrate understanding of and use commas and end punctuation while reading orally.
- Read aloud, alone, or with a partner at least 15 minutes each day.

E. Reading Comprehension—All Texts

Teachers: It is important to recognize that kindergartners are taught only some of the many letter-sound correspondences a reader needs to know to read a wide range of printed material. As a result, many kindergartners will be able to read only the simplest written text independently. At this grade level, mental energy will be directed primarily to the act of reading, i.e., decoding. A focus on the mechanics of decoding is appropriate and desirable at this early stage in the reading process. In kindergarten, attention to reading comprehension should be directed to ensuring a fundamental understanding of what has been read. At this

grade level, it will generally be more effective and efficient to devote time to higher level thinking and comprehension skills at the listening and speaking level in response to written texts that are read aloud.

- Demonstrate understanding of simple decodable text after reading independently.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Answer questions requiring literal recall and understanding of the details and/or facts (i.e., who, what, where, when, etc.) about a text that has been read independently.
- Retell or dramatize a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence.
- Use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions, a scene or facts from a text that has been read independently.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Understand and use words and phrases from a text that has been read independently.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to reading, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read.
- Use pictures accompanying the written text to check and support understanding.
- Make predictions prior to and while reading, based on the title, pictures, and/or text read thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.
- Identify who is telling a story or providing information in a text.

III. Writing

Teachers: It is important to recognize that of all the communication skills—listening, speaking, reading, and writing—writing is the most demanding and challenging, especially for kindergartners who are just learning not only the code, but the fine motor skills and letter strokes necessary to put something down on paper. Kindergartners can, however, express themselves in writing by drawing pictures and, as they begin to learn some of the code, copying or writing words, phrases, and sentences.

In addition, students can also participate in shared writing exercises modeled and scaffolded by an adult. The focus in shared writing should be on encouraging the students to verbally express themselves coherently and in complete sentences, as the teacher serves as a scribe.

Writing to Reflect Audience, Purpose and Task

- Draw pictures to represent a text that has been heard or read independently.
- Draw pictures to represent a preference or opinion.
- Write narratives, informative and explanatory texts, and offer an opinion through shared writing exercises.
- With assistance, add details to writing.
- Create a title or caption to accompany a picture and/or shared writing.

IV. Language Conventions

- Form letters, words, phrases and sentences to communicate thoughts and ideas.
- Apply basic spelling conventions.
- Use basic capitalization and punctuation in sentences to convey meaning.

A. Handwriting and Spelling

- Hold a pencil with a pincer grasp and make marks on paper.
- Trace, copy, and print from memory the 26 letters of the alphabet accurately in both their upper-case and lower-case forms.

- Write own name.
- Write from left to right, leaving spaces between words, and top to bottom using return sweep.
- Begin to write phonemically plausible spellings for words that cannot be spelled correctly with current code knowledge, e.g., write *bote* for *boat*, *sum* for *some*, *hunee* for *honey*.
- Write words, phrases, and sentences from dictation, applying phonics knowledge.

B. Parts of Speech and Sentence Structure

- Use and understand question words, i.e., *what, where, when, who, how*.
- Form regular plural nouns by adding 's' or 'es', i.e., *dog, dogs, wish, wishes*.
- Demonstrate understanding of frequently occurring prepositions, i.e., *to/from, in/out, on/off*.
- Produce and expand complete sentences orally and in shared writing exercises.

C. Capitalization and Punctuation

- Capitalize the first word in a sentence; the pronoun *I*.
- Identify and use end punctuation, including periods, question marks, and exclamation points.

Note Regarding Preschool Content:

Some of the poems and stories specified here are appropriate for preschoolers. Indeed, one would hope that most preschoolers would come to kindergarten having heard, for example, some Mother Goose rhymes or the story of "Goldilocks and the Three Bears." However, as not all children attend preschool, and as home preparation varies, the *Core Knowledge Sequence* offers a core of familiar rhymes and stories for all kindergarten students. See also the *Core Knowledge Preschool Sequence*, available from the Core Knowledge Foundation.

V. Poetry

Teachers: Students should be introduced to a varied selection of poetry with strong rhyme and rhythm. Students should hear these rhymes read aloud, and should say some of them aloud. Some rhymes may also be sung to familiar melodies. The poems listed here represent some of the most popular and widely anthologized titles; students may certainly be introduced to more Mother Goose rhymes beyond the selection below. Although students are not expected to memorize the following rhymes, they will delight in knowing their favorites by heart, and will experience a sense of achievement and satisfaction in being able to recite some of the rhymes.

A. Mother Goose and Other Traditional Poems

- "A Diller, A Dollar"
- "Baa, Baa, Black Sheep"
- "Diddle, Diddle, Dumpling"
- "Early to Bed"
- "Georgie Porgie"
- "Hey Diddle Diddle"
- "Hickory, Dickory, Dock"
- "Hot Cross Buns"
- "Humpty Dumpty"
- "It's Raining, It's Pouring"
- "Jack and Jill"
- "Jack Be Nimble"
- "Jack Sprat"
- "Ladybug, Ladybug"
- "Little Bo Peep"
- "Little Boy Blue"
- "Little Jack Horner"
- "Little Miss Muffet"
- "London Bridge Is Falling Down"
- "Mary, Mary, Quite Contrary"
- "Old King Cole"
- "Old Mother Hubbard"

"One, Two, Buckle My Shoe"
 "Pat-a-Cake"
 "Rain, Rain, Go Away"
 "Ride a Cock-Horse"
 "Ring Around the Rosey"
 "Rock-a-bye, Baby"
 "Roses Are Red"
 "See-Saw, Margery Daw"
 "Simple Simon"
 "Sing a Song of Sixpence"
 "Star Light, Star Bright"
 "There Was a Little Girl"
 "There Was an Old Woman Who Lived in a Shoe"
 "This Little Pig Went to Market"
 "Three Blind Mice"

Note: The poems listed here constitute a selected core of poetry for this grade. You are encouraged to expose students to more poetry, old and new. To bring students into the spirit of poetry, read it aloud and encourage them to speak it aloud so they can experience the music in the words.

B. Other Poems, Old and New

"April Rain Song" (Langston Hughes)
 "Happy Thought" (Robert Louis Stevenson)
 "I Do Not Mind You, Winter Wind" (Jack Prelutsky)
 "Mary Had a Little Lamb" (Sara Josepha Hale)
 "The More It Snows" (A. A. Milne)
 "My Nose" (Dorothy Aldis)
 "Rain" (Robert Louis Stevenson)
 "Three Little Kittens" (Eliza Lee Follen)
 "Time to Rise" (Robert Louis Stevenson)
 "Tommy" (Gwendolyn Brooks)
 "Twinkle Twinkle Little Star" (Jane Taylor)

VI. Fiction

Teachers: While the following works make up a strong core of literature, the content of language arts includes not only stories, fables, and poems, but also the well-practiced, operational knowledge of how written symbols represent sounds, and how those sounds and symbols convey meaning. Thus, the stories specified below are meant to complement, not to replace, materials designed to help students practice decoding and encoding skills (see above, II. Reading and III. Writing).

The following works constitute a core of stories for this grade. In kindergarten, these stories are meant to be read-aloud selections. Expose students to many more stories, including classic picture books and read-aloud books. (In schools, teachers across grade levels should communicate their choices in order to avoid undue repetition.) Students should also be exposed to nonfiction prose: biographies, books on science and history, books on art and music, etc. And, students should be given opportunities to tell and write their own stories.

A. Stories

"The Bremen Town Musicians" (Brothers Grimm)
 "Chicken Little" (also known as "Henny-Penny")
 "Cinderella" (Charles Perrault)
 "Goldilocks and the Three Bears"
 "How Many Spots Does a Leopard Have?" (African folktale)
 "King Midas and the Golden Touch"
 "The Legend of Jumping Mouse" (Native American: Northern Plains legend)

"The Little Red Hen"
 "Little Red Riding Hood"
 "Momotaro: Peach Boy" (Japanese folktale)
 "Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs"
 "The Three Billy Goats Gruff"
 "The Three Little Pigs"
 "A Tug of War" (African folktale)
 "The Ugly Duckling" (Hans Christian Andersen)
 "The Velveteen Rabbit" (Margery Williams)
 selections from "Winnie-the-Pooh" (A. A. Milne)
 "The Wolf and the Kids" (Brothers Grimm)

B. Aesop's Fables

"The Lion and the Mouse"
 "The Grasshopper and the Ants"
 "The Dog and His Shadow"
 "The Hare and the Tortoise"

C. American Folk Heroes and Tall Tales

Johnny Appleseed
 Casey Jones

D. Literary Terms

Teachers: As students become familiar with stories, discuss the following:

- author
- illustrator

E. Sayings and Phrases

Teachers: Every culture has phrases and proverbs that make no sense when carried over literally into another culture. For many students, this section may not be needed; they will have picked up these sayings by hearing them at home and among friends. But the sayings have been one of the categories most appreciated by teachers who work with students from home cultures that differ from the standard culture of literate American English.

A dog is man's best friend.
 April showers bring May flowers.
 Better safe than sorry
 Do unto others as you would have them do unto you.
 The early bird gets the worm.
 Great oaks from little acorns grow.
 Look before you leap
 A place for everything and everything in its place
 Practice makes perfect.
 [It's] raining cats and dogs.
 Where there's a will there's a way.

Note: Children will read more American folk heroes and tall tales in Grade 2.



Teachers: In kindergarten, students often study aspects of the world around them: the family, the school, the community, etc. The following guidelines are meant to broaden and complement that focus. The goal of studying selected topics in World History in Kindergarten is to foster curiosity and the beginnings of understanding about the larger world outside the student's locality, and about varied civilizations and ways of life. This can be done through a variety of means: story, drama, art, music, discussion, and more.

The study of geography embraces many topics throughout the Core Knowledge Sequence, including topics in history and science. Geographic knowledge includes a spatial sense of the world, an awareness of the physical processes that shape life, a sense of the interactions between humans and their environment, an understanding of the relations between place and culture, and an awareness of the characteristics of specific regions and cultures.

It is important that students learn about the people who shaped our world, as well as those who continue to do so. Thus, it is recommended that students listen to a variety of biographies. Engaging students in read-alouds about the individuals listed in the Sequence, and others, enables them to draw from a broader perspective.

World History and Geography

I. Geography: Spatial Sense (working with maps, globes, and other geographic tools)

Teachers: Foster students' geographical awareness through regular work with maps and globes. Have students regularly locate themselves on maps and globes in relation to places they are studying. Students should make and use a simple map of a locality (such as classroom, home, school grounds) or a map for a treasure hunt.

- Maps and globes: what they represent, how we use them
- Rivers, lakes, and mountains: what they are and how they are represented on maps and globes
- Locate the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans
- Locate the North and South Poles

II. An Overview of the Seven Continents

Teachers: Help students gain a beginning geographic vocabulary and a basic sense of how we organize and talk about the world by giving names to some of the biggest pieces of land. Introduce students to the seven continents through a variety of methods and media (tracing, coloring, relief maps, etc.), and associate the continents with familiar wildlife, landmarks, peoples, cultures, etc., for example, penguins in Antarctica; or the Eiffel Tower in Europe. Throughout the school year, reinforce names and locations of continents when potential connections arise in other disciplines, for example, connect Grimm's fairy tales to Europe, the voyage of Pilgrims to Europe and North America the story of "Momotaro—Peach Boy" to Asia [Japan], or the study of Native Americans to North America.

- Identify and locate the seven continents on a map and globe:
 - Asia
 - Europe
 - Africa
 - North America
 - South America
 - Antarctica
 - Australia

Note: In later grades, students will continue to learn about all of the continents as well as specific countries and peoples.



Isabella I of Castile and Ferdinand II of Aragon.

Note: No historical evidence exists to confirm Plymouth Rock as the Pilgrims' steppingstone to the New World. In fact, it is believed that the Pilgrims first made landfall on the tip of Cape Cod in November 1620 before sailing to safer harbors in Plymouth the following month. William Bradford, and his fellow Mayflower passengers, made no written references to setting foot on a rock as they disembarked to start their settlement on a new continent.

Note: Discussing slavery with younger students is a very challenging task. Slavery, which has existed for thousands of years in many cultures, is by definition an inhumane practice—people are reduced to property, to be bought and sold, and often treated with brutality and violence. Classroom discussion of slavery should acknowledge its cruelty while remaining mindful of the age of the students.

Note: Discuss with students "What does it mean to be free?"

American History and Geography

Teachers: The study of American history begins in Grades K-2 with a brief overview of major events and figures, from the earliest days to recent times. A more in-depth, chronological study of American history begins again in grade 3 and continues onward. The term "American" here generally, but not always, refers to the lands that became the United States. Other topics regarding North, Central, and South America may be found in the World History and Geography sections of this Sequence.

I. Geography

- Name and locate the town, city, or community, as well as the state where you live.
- Locate North America, the continental United States, Alaska, and Hawaii.

II. Native American Peoples, Past and Present

Teachers: As students progress through the grades of the Core Knowledge Sequence, they will learn about many different Native American peoples in many different regions (such as Pacific Northwest: Kwakiutl [Kwakwaka'wakw, Chinook]; Plateau: Nez Perce; Great Basin: Shoshone, Ute; Southwest: Dine [Navajo], Hopi, Apache, Zuni; Plains: Blackfoot, Comanche, Crow, Kiowa, Dakota, Lakota [Sioux], Cheyenne, Arapaho; Eastern Woodlands: Huron, Iroquois, Mohican, Delaware [Lenni Lenape], Susquehanna, Massachusetts, Wampanoag, Powhatan; Southeast: Cherokee, Seminole). In kindergarten, study at least one specific group of Native Americans. You might explore a local or regional tribe or nation, and compare it with one far away.

- Become familiar with the people and ways of life of at least one Native American tribe or nation, including:
 - The landscape and environment they lived in
 - how they lived
 - what they wore and ate
 - the homes they lived in
 - their beliefs and stories
 - the current status of the tribe or nation

III. Early Exploration and Settlement

Teachers: Columbus Day is an important holiday for many Americans, but in some states the holiday has been renamed Indigenous People's Day in recognition of the harm that was caused to the indigenous peoples of the Americas by explorers, adventurers, and settlers from Europe. In fact, Columbus did enslave the Taino people and take them back to Europe with him. Although elements of Columbus's story are dark, his voyages do mark a great change in the history of the world.

A. The Voyage of Columbus (Cristoforo Colombo) in 1492

- Queen Isabella and King Ferdinand of Spain
- The Niña, Pinta, and Santa Maria
- Columbus's mistaken identification of "Indies" and "Indians"
- The idea of what was, for Europeans, a "New World"

B. The Pilgrims

- The Mayflower
- Plymouth Rock
- Thanksgiving Day celebration

C. July 4, "Independence Day"

- The "birthday" of our nation
- Democracy (rule of the people): Americans wanted to rule themselves instead of being ruled by a faraway king
- Some people were not free: slavery in early America

See below, Symbols and Figures: Mount Rushmore; the White House.

IV. Presidents, Past and Present

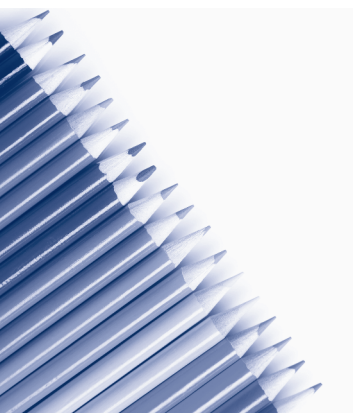
Teachers: Introduce students to famous presidents, and discuss with them such questions as: What is the president? How does a person become president? Who are some of our most famous presidents, and what did they do that made them famous?

- George Washington
 - The “Father of Our Country”
 - Legend of George Washington and the cherry tree
- Thomas Jefferson, author of Declaration of Independence
- Abraham Lincoln
 - Humble origins
 - “Honest Abe”
- Theodore Roosevelt
 - National Park initiative
- Barrack Obama
 - First Black American president
- Current United States president

V. Symbols and Figures

- Recognize and become familiar with the significance of
 - American flag
 - Statue of Liberty
 - Mount Rushmore
 - The White House

Kindergarten | Visual Arts



Teachers: In schools, lessons on the visual arts should illustrate important elements of making and appreciating art, and emphasize important artists, works of art, and artistic concepts. When appropriate, topics in the visual arts may be linked to topics in other disciplines. The following guidelines specify a variety of artwork in different media and from various cultures in order to expose students to a wide range of art and artists. While the list is robust, it may require teachers to narrow the selection in order to adequately address the works and related skills within an academic year.

I. Elements of Art

Teachers: The generally recognized elements of art include line, shape, form, space, light, texture, and color. In kindergarten, introduce students to line and color. Engage students in recognizing and using different kinds of lines and colors, and point out lines and colors in nature. (You may also wish to observe shapes in art and nature—see Math: Geometry.)

A. Color

- Observe how colors can create different feelings and how certain colors can seem “warm” (red, orange, yellow) or “cool” (blue, green, purple).
- Observe the use of color in
 - Pieter Bruegel, *The Hunters in the Snow*
 - Helen Frankenthaler, *Blue Atmosphere*
 - Paul Gauguin, *Tahitian Landscape*
 - Pablo Picasso, *Le Gourmet*
 - Alice Neel, *Two Girls in Spanish Harlem*, 1941
 - Louis Smoky Kaulaity, *Lullaby* (mid-20th c)
 - Mandy Martin, *Evening Clouds* (2014)

B. Line

- Identify and use different lines: straight, zigzag, curved, wavy, thick, thin
- Observe different kinds of lines in
 - Katsushika Hokusai, *Tuning the Samisen*
 - Henri Matisse, *Purple Robe and Anemones*
 - Joan Miró, *People and Dog in the Sun*
 - Käthe Kollwitz, *Sleeping Woman and Child* (1929)
 - William H. Johnson, *Li’L Sis* (1944)
 - Horace Pippin, *Family Supper* (1946)

C. Artworks

Teachers: After students have been introduced to some elements of art and a range of artworks and artists, engage them in looking at pictures and talking about them. Ask the students about their first impressions—what they notice first, and what the picture makes them think of or feel. Go on to discuss the lines and colors, details not obvious at first, why they think the artist chose to depict things in a certain way, etc.

Compare Kollwitz’s *Sleeping Women and Child* to Picasso’s *Mother & Child*

II. Sculpture

- Recognize and discuss the following as sculptures:
- Northwest American Indian totem pole
- Alexander Calder’s *Lobster Trap and Fish Tail*
- Sandy Skoglund, *Gathering Paradise* (1991)

See also American History Grade K: Native Americans, re totem pole

Note: When studying the Hall of Supreme Harmony, draw students' attention to the shape of a diagonal, like that of a pitched roof, as well as the horizontal line of beams resting on the vertical lines of columns. Discuss with students how the shape and design of these columns enable them to hold up the heavy materials above.

Note: When reviewing the Eiffel Tower point out how the structure becomes increasingly thin at the top.

Note: When looking at the Sydney Opera House, discuss the curvature of the roof profile and how this is a shape that copies similar shapes in nature.

- Look at and discuss:
 - Pieter Bruegel, *Children's Games*
 - Winslow Homer, *Snap the Whip*
 - Diego Rivera, *The Mother's Helper*
 - Henry O. Tanner, *The Banjo Lesson*
 - Maria Izquierdo, *My Nieces* (1940)
 - Mark Tansey, *Snowman*, (2004)

III. Architecture

Teachers: These structures offer the opportunity for students to explore different architectural shapes and lines as well as begin to think how the design helps the building stand up.

- Explore different architectural shapes and lines in buildings, such as
 - Hall of Supreme Harmony (1406)
 - Eiffel Tower (1887)
 - Sydney Opera House (1973)

Kindergarten | Music



Teachers: In schools, lessons on music should feature activities and works that illustrate important musical concepts and terms, and should introduce important composers and works. When appropriate, topics in music may be linked to topics in other disciplines. The following guidelines focus on content, not performance skills, though many concepts are best learned through active practice (singing, clapping rhythms, playing instruments, etc.).

I. Elements of Music

- Through participation, become familiar with some basic elements of music (rhythm, melody, harmony, form, timbre, etc.).
- Recognize a steady beat; begin to play a steady beat.
- Recognize that some beats have accents (stress).
- Move responsively to music (marching, walking, hopping, swaying, etc.).
- Participate in call and response activities (e.g., “John the Rabbit”)
- Engage in improvisation activities (e.g., “All Around the Kitchen,” “Little Johnny Brown”)
- Participate in play party activities (e.g., “The Farmer in the Dell,” “The Paw-Paw Patch,” “Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush,” “The Hokey Pokey”).
- Recognize short and long sounds.
- Discriminate between fast and slow.
- Discriminate between obvious differences in pitch: high and low.
- Discriminate between loud and soft
- Recognize that some phrases are the same, some different.
- Sing unaccompanied, accompanied, and in unison.

II. Listening and Understanding

Teachers: To encourage listening skills and the beginnings of understanding, play various kinds of music often and repeatedly. In the kindergarten classroom, music can be played for enjoyment, to accompany activities, to inspire creative movement, etc. Expose children to a wide range of music, including children’s music, popular instrumental music, and music from various cultures.

- Recognize the following instruments by sight and sound:
 - guitar
 - piano
 - trumpet
 - flute
 - violin
 - drum
- Become familiar with the following works:
 - Edvard Grieg, “Morning Mood” and “In the Hall of the Mountain King” from *Peer Gynt*
 - Victor Herbert, “March of the Toys” from *Babes in Toyland*
 - Camille Saint-Saëns, *Carnival of the Animals*
 - Ella Fitzgerald, “A Tisket, A Tasket”

Note: Grieg’s “In the Hall of the Mountain King” is a good work to illustrate dynamics (loud and quiet), as well as tempo (slow and fast).

III. Songs

Teachers: See also Language Arts, Mother Goose poems. A number of the poems may be sung to familiar melodies.

“The Bear Went Over the Mountain”
 “Bingo”

"Go In and Out the Window"
"Go Tell Aunt Rhody"
"Here We Go Round the Mulberry Bush"
"If You're Happy and You Know It"
"Jingle Bells"
"John Jacob Jingleheimer Schmidt"
"Kumbaya" (also "Kum Ba Ya")
"London Bridge"
"Old MacDonald Had a Farm"
"Row, Row, Row Your Boat"
"This Old Man"
"Twinkle Twinkle Little Star"
"The Wheels on the Bus"
"A Ram Sam Sam"
"Fais Dodo"
"Pin Pon"
"This Little Light of Mine"
"Oh, John the Rabbit"

Teachers: You may wish to supplement the songs listed above with songs from the *Core Knowledge Preschool Sequence*, as follows:

"Are You Sleeping?"
"Do Your Ears Hang Low?"
"Did You Ever See a Lassie?"
"Eensy, Weensy Spider"
"Five Little Ducks That I Once Knew"
"Five Little Monkeys Jumping On the Bed"
"Happy Birthday to You"
"Head and Shoulders, Knees and Toes"
"Here is the Beehive"
"I'm a Little Teapot"
"Kookaburra"
"Lazy Mary"
"Looby Loo"
"Oats, Peas, Beans and Barley Grow"
"Oh, Do You Know the Muffin Man?"
"Oh Where, Oh Where, Has My Little Dog Gone?"
"One Potato, Two Potato"
"Open, Shut Them"
"Pop Goes the Weasel"
"Teddy Bear, Teddy Bear, Turn Around"
"Teddy Bears Picnic"
"Where is Thumbkin?"
"Who Stole the Cookie from the Cookie Jar?"
"You Are My Sunshine"

Kindergarten | Mathematics



Teachers: Mathematics has its own vocabulary and patterns of thinking. It is a discipline with its own language and conventions. Thus, while some lessons may offer occasional opportunities for linking mathematics to other disciplines, it is critically important to attend to math as math. From the earliest years, mathematics requires incremental review and steady practice: not only the diligent effort required to master basic facts and operations, but also thoughtful and varied practice that approaches problems from a variety of angles, and gives children a variety of opportunities to apply the same concept or operation in different types of situations. While it is important to work toward the development of “higher-order problem-solving skills,” it is equally important—indeed, it is prerequisite to achieving “higher order” skills—to have a sound grasp of basic facts, and an automatic fluency with fundamental operations.

I. Counting and Cardinality

- Know number names and the count sequence.
 - Count to 100 by ones and by tens.
 - Count forward beginning from a given number within the known sequence.
 - Write numbers from 0 to 20.
 - Represent a number of objects with a written numeral 0–20.
- Count to tell the number of objects.
 - Understand the relationship between numbers and quantities.
 - Connect counting to cardinality.
 - Count to answer “how many?” questions,
 - With as many as 20 things arranged in a line, a rectangular array, or a circle;
 - With as many as 10 things in a scattered configuration.
 - Given a number from 1–20, count out that many objects.
- Compare numbers.
 - Identify whether the number of objects in one group is greater than, less than, or equal to the number of objects in another group.
 - Compare two numbers between 1 and 10 presented as written numerals.

II. Operations and Algebraic Thinking

- Understand addition as putting together and adding to, and understand subtraction as taking apart and taking from.
 - Represent addition and subtraction with:
 - objects
 - fingers
 - mental images
 - drawings
 - sounds (e.g., claps)
 - acting out situations
 - verbal explanations
 - expressions
 - equations
 - Solve addition and subtraction word problems (within 10).
 - Decompose numbers less than or equal to 10 into pairs in more than one way.
 - Record each decomposition by a drawing or equation.
 - For any number from 1 to 9, find the number that makes 10 when added to the given number.
 - Record the answer with a drawing or equation.
 - Fluently add and subtract within 5.

III. Number and Operations in Base Ten

- Work with numbers 11–19 to gain foundations for place value.
 - Understand that numbers are composed of ten ones and one, two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, or nine ones.
 - Compose and decompose numbers from 11 to 19 into ten ones.
 - Record each composition or decomposition by a drawing or equation.

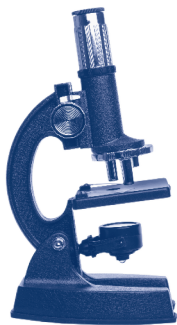
IV. Measurement and Data

- Describe and compare measurable attributes.
 - Describe measurable attributes of objects, such as length or weight.
 - Describe several measurable attributes of a single object.
- Directly compare two objects with a measurable attribute in common, to see which object has “more of”/“less of” the attribute, and describe the difference.
 - Classify objects into given categories.
 - Count the numbers of objects in each category and sort the categories by count.

V. Geometry

- Identify and describe shapes (squares, circles, triangles, rectangles, hexagons, cubes, cones, cylinders, and spheres).
 - Describe objects in the environment using names of shapes, and describe the relative positions of these objects.
 - Correctly name shapes regardless of their orientations or overall size.
 - Identify shapes as two-dimensional (lying in a plane, “flat”) or three-dimensional (“solid”).
- Analyze, compare, create, and compose shapes.
 - Analyze and compare two- and three-dimensional shapes:
 - In different sizes and orientations;
 - Using informal language to describe their similarities, differences, parts and other attributes.
 - Model shapes in the world by building shapes from components and drawing shapes.
 - Compose simple shapes to form larger shapes.

Kindergarten | Science



Teachers: Effective instruction in science requires hands-on experience and observation. In the words of the report from the National Academies of Science, *A Framework for K-12 Science Education*, "...children entering kindergarten have surprisingly sophisticated ways of thinking about the world, based in part on their direct experiences with the physical environment such as watching objects fall or collide and observing plants and animals. They also learn about the world through everyday activities, such as talking with their families, pursuing hobbies, watching television, and playing with friends. As children try to understand and influence the world around them, they develop ideas about their role in that world and how it works. In fact, the capacity of young children—from all backgrounds and socioeconomic levels—to reason in sophisticated ways is much greater than has long been assumed. Although they may lack deep knowledge and extensive experience, they often engage in a wide range of subtle and complex reasoning about the world. Thus, before they even enter school, children have developed their own ideas about the physical, biological, and social worlds and how they work. By listening to and taking these ideas seriously, educators can build on what children already know and can do."

While experience counts for much, book learning is also important, for it helps bring coherence and order to a child's scientific knowledge. Only when topics are presented systematically and clearly can children make steady and secure progress in their scientific learning. The child's development of scientific knowledge and understanding is in some ways a very disorderly and complex process, different for each child. But a systematic approach to the exploration of science, one that combines experience with book learning, can help provide essential building blocks for deeper understanding at a later time.

I. Pushes and Pulls

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as identifying examples of different kinds of pushes and pulls, explore the following with students:

A. Pushes and Pulls are Forces

- A force is a push or a pull.
- Pushes and pulls can involve direct or indirect contact between objects.
- Pushes and pulls can be explored in everyday life.

B. Pushes and Pulls can Change an Object's Motion

- Pushes and pulls can cause objects that are not moving, or at rest, to move.
- Pushes and pulls can change the motion, —the speed and/or direction—of objects.
 - When objects collide with one another, the motions of the colliding objects can change direction.

C. Magnetism is a Force

- Magnetism and gravity are examples of indirect, non-contact forces.
- Magnets are certain metals that can push or pull some metal objects.
- Magnets have two ends, called poles, that behave differently.
- Magnets can be useful in everyday devices (cabinet doors, refrigerator magnets).

II. Needs of Plants and Animals

Teachers: Through reading aloud, observation, and activities such as investigating growing plants in your classroom, introduce students to the needs of living things. Students should explore the following:

A. Plants and Animals

- A living thing is an organism.
- Organisms can grow, respond to environments, reproduce, and use food energy for life processes.
- Plants are organisms.

Collaborate with your third grade colleagues regarding future expectations and definitions of forces. Grade 3, Investigating Forces

- There are many types of plants.
- Most plants have stems, roots, and leaves.
- Animals are organisms.
 - There are many types of animals .
 - Animals have certain parts for certain functions (structure: exoskeleton or skeleton; movement: legs, fins, wings; nutrition: mouth, digestive tract; protection: fur, shell).

B. Plants, Their Needs, and Their Environments

- Plants need air, water, light, and space.
- Plants get what they need from their environment.
- Different types of plants live in different types of environments.
- Plants make their own food using sunlight and air.

C. Animals, Their Needs, and Their Environments

- Animals need air, food, water, and shelter to survive.
- Animals get what they need from their environments.
- Different types of animals live in different types of environments.
- Animals get their food from eating other living things.

D. Humans, Their Needs, and Their Environments

- Human beings are a type of animal.
- Humans need air, food, water, shelter to survive.
- Humans get what they need from their environment.
- Humans are omnivores.

III. Changing Environments

Teachers: The emphasis in kindergarten should be on observation, description, and explanation of real world experiences of different environments and the exploration of how natural spaces can change over time. Technical explanations of ecological phenomena and human impacts on the environment should be taken up in later grades; see Grades 2, 3, and 5 for an increasingly more detailed study of Ecology:

A. Ecosystems

- Plants and animals live in environments that meet their needs.
 - habitats, ecosystems
- Changes in environment affect the organisms that live there.

B. Plants in Ecosystems

- Plants, such as water hyacinth and kudzu, can change ecosystems, affecting the ability of other living things in the ecosystem to meet their own needs.

C. Animals in Ecosystems

- Animals, such as the zebra mussel and the beaver, can change ecosystems, affecting the ability of other living things in the ecosystem to meet their own needs.

D. Human Changes in Ecosystems

- Humans can change ecosystems through roads, cities, pollution, etc. affecting the ability of other living things in the ecosystem to meet their own needs.

E. People Design Solutions to Reduce Human Impact

- People can make choices to reduce the amount of change they cause to ecosystems:
 - Sustainable farming, reforestation, recycling, and pollution reduction

Collaborate with your fifth grade colleagues to connect this topic to learning in Grade 5, Protecting Earth's Resources.

IV. Weather Patterns

Teachers: The emphasis in kindergarten should be on observation, description, and explanation of real world experiences; technical explanations of meteorological phenomena should be taken up in later grades; see grades 3 and 5 for an increasingly detailed study of Meteorology:

A. Sunlight

- The sun is a star that lights the sky during the daytime.
- Sunlight warms Earth's surface.
- Blocking sunlight reduces its warming effect on Earth's surface and materials.

B. Patterns in Weather Conditions

- Weather is what the air is like outside at any one time and place.
- People collect and record weather data, such as temperature, rainfall, wind speed and direction, to reveal patterns.
- Seasons are repeating patterns of weather within the course of a year.

C. Severe Weather

- Weather can be severe and can cause damage, for example, thunder, lightning, heavy rain, high wind, tornadoes, hail, blizzards, hurricanes, drought, and heat waves.
- Looking at patterns in weather data helps people predict, or forecast, when severe weather will occur.

V. The Human Body: Our Five Senses

A. Vision and Hearing

- Vision is the ability to detect objects by light.
 - Eyes are the organs of vision.
- Hearing is the ability to detect sound.
 - The ears are the organs of hearing.
- The senses of sight and hearing enable people to perform many important tasks.
- Corrective lenses and hearing aids may help with vision and hearing impairments.
 - Other ways to help those with impaired hearing or vision include sign language, assistive animals, and braille.

B. Smell, Taste, and Touch

- The sense of smell is the ability to detect scent/odor.
 - The nose is the organ of smell.
- The sense of taste is the ability to detect chemicals in the environment.
 - The taste buds enable a sense of taste.
- The sense of touch is the ability to feel things in the environment.
 - Nerves in the skin enable a sense of touch.

C. Taking Care of Your Body

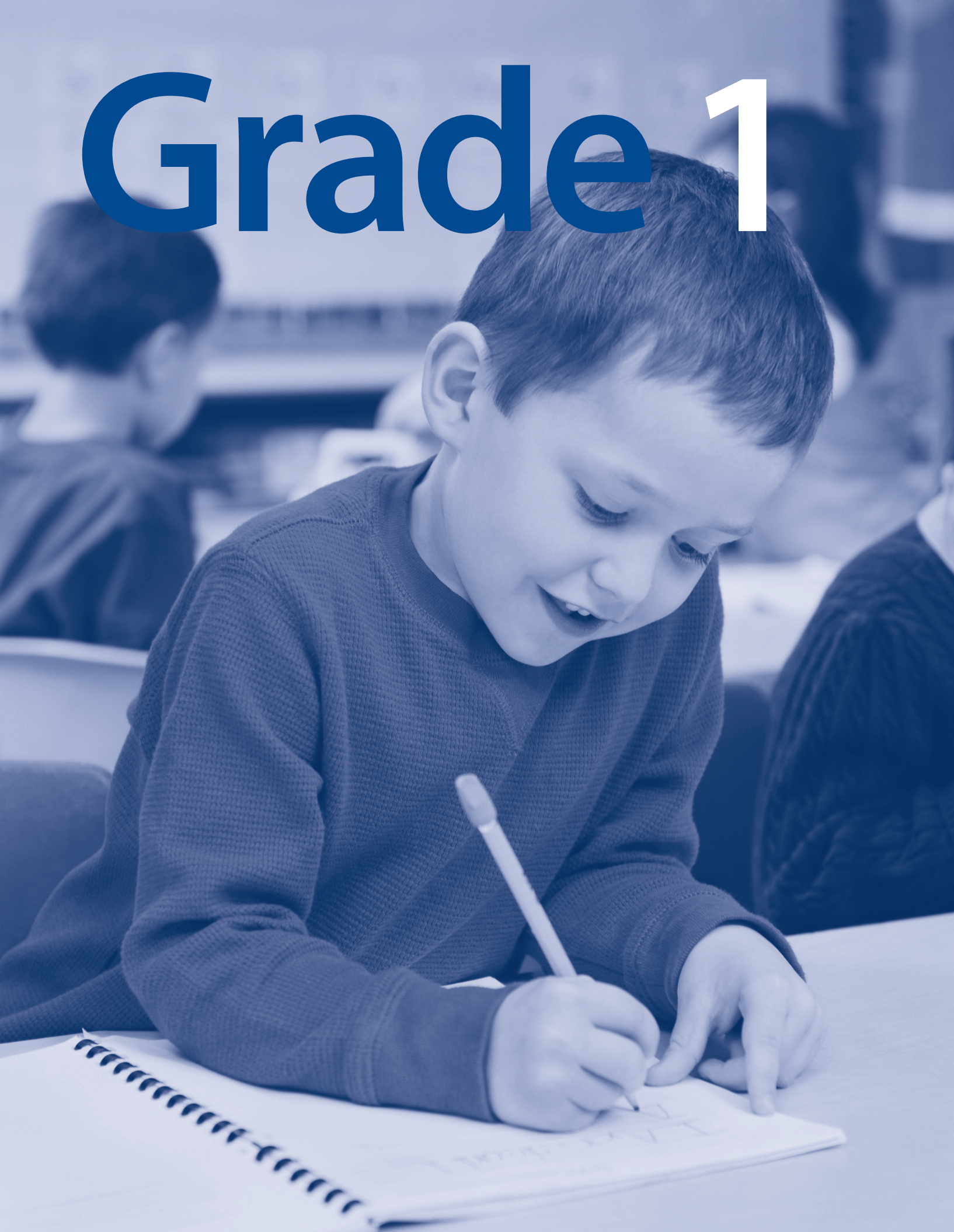
- Proper care of the body helps all senses to work most effectively.
- Healthy foods promote wellness of the senses.

VI. Science Biographies

Teachers: Through reading aloud and activities, explore with students the stories and accomplishments of these scientists and engineers. This list of science biographies is by no means exhaustive. Other individuals can be incorporated into learning during a corresponding topic of study for this grade level, and should include:

- Isaac Newton—English physicist and mathematician, described the roles of forces in the universe
- Rachel Carson—discussed the dangers of pesticides
- George Washington Carver—used plants for human benefit
- Abbe Cleveland—founded the National Weather Service

Grade 1



Overview of Topics

Grade 1

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

- I. Listening and Speaking
 - A. Classroom Discussion
 - B. Presentation of Ideas and Information
 - C. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—All Texts
 - D. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry
 - E. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Nonfiction and Informational Text
- II. Reading
 - A. Print Awareness
 - B. Phonological and Phonemic Awareness
 - C. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding
 - D. Oral Reading and Fluency
 - E. Reading Comprehension—All Texts
 - F. Reading Comprehension—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry
 - G. Reading Comprehension—Nonfiction and Informational Text
- III. Writing
 - A. Narrative Writing
 - B. Informative/Explanatory Writing
 - C. Persuasive Writing (Opinion)
- IV. Language Conventions
 - A. Handwriting and Spelling
 - B. Parts of Speech and Sentence Structure
 - C. Capitalization and Punctuation
- V. Poetry
- VI. Fiction
 - A. Stories
 - B. Aesop's Fables
 - C. Different Lands, Similar Stories
 - D. Literary Terms
 - E. Sayings and Phrases

HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

WORLD HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. Geography
 - A. Spatial Sense
 - B. Geographical terms and features
- II. Early World Civilizations
 - A. Mesopotamia: the "cradle of civilization"
 - B. Ancient Egypt
 - C. History of World Religions
- III. Modern Civilization and Culture: Mexico
 - A. Geography
 - B. Culture

AMERICAN HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

- I. Early People and Civilizations
 - A. The Earliest People: Hunters and Nomads
 - B. Early American Civilizations
- II. Early Exploration and Settlement
 - A. Columbus
 - B. The Conquistadors
 - C. English Settlers
- III. From Colonies to Independence: The American Revolution

- IV. Early Exploration of the American West
- V. Symbols and Figures

VISUAL ARTS

- I. Art from Long Ago
- II. Elements of Art
 - A. Color
 - B. Line
 - C. Shape
 - D. Texture
- III. Kinds of Pictures
 - A. Portrait
 - B. Still Life
 - C. Murals
- IV. Architecture

MUSIC

- I. Elements of Music
- II. Listening and Understanding
 - A. Musical Terms and Concepts
 - B. Music Can Tell a Story
 - C. American Musical Traditions
- III. Songs

MATHEMATICS

- I. Operations and Algebraic Thinking
- II. Number and Operations in Base Ten
- III. Measurement and Data
- IV. Geometry

SCIENCE

- I. Sun, Moon, and Stars
 - A. The Sun and Its Predictable Patterns
 - B. Annual Patterns of Sunrise and Sunset
 - C. The Moon and Its Predictable Patterns
 - D. Stars and Their Predictable Patterns
- II. Plant and Animal Survival
 - A. Structure and Function in Plants and Animals
 - B. Information Processing: Plant and Animal Stimulus and Response
 - C. Growth and Development
 - D. Parents and Offspring
- III. Exploring Light and Sound
 - A. Sound and Vibration
 - B. Light
 - C. Light and Materials
 - D. Solving Problems with Light or Sound
- IV. Simple Machines
 - A. Simple Machines
 - B. Compound Machines
- V. The Human Body: Human Body Systems
 - A. Skeletal and Muscular Systems
 - B. Respiratory and Circulatory Systems
 - C. Nervous System
 - D. Taking Care of your Body
- VI. Science Graphiques



The *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts* emphasize the critical importance of building nonfiction background knowledge in a coherent and sequenced way within and across grades. This can be accomplished most effectively, at each grade level, by integrating the topics from history, geography, science, and the arts in the *Core Knowledge Sequence* into the language arts block. Note that in the Sequence, there are many cross-curricular connections to history and science topics within Language Arts (e.g., poems, stories, and sayings), as well as to visual arts and music, which can and should be integrated into the applicable domain of study.

NOTE: The objectives listed in sections I–IV of Language Arts below are consistent with the *Core Knowledge Language Arts* program and embed all of the skills and concepts within the *Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts*.

I. Listening and Speaking

Teachers: Traditional language arts instruction has typically accorded little, if any, attention to the ongoing development of children’s listening and speaking ability. This failure to focus on the development of oral language in language arts instruction has been a serious oversight. Literacy, the ability to read and write written language, is highly correlated with students’ oral language proficiency, and the ability to understand a text read aloud is a prerequisite for making sense of the same text in printed form. It is therefore essential that children build listening and speaking competency while also developing reading and writing skills.

A. Classroom Discussion

- Participate in age appropriate activities involving listening and speaking.
- Speak clearly with volume appropriate to the setting.
- Use agreed-upon rules for group discussions, i.e., look at and listen to the speaker, raise hand to speak, take turns, say “excuse me” or “please,” etc.
- Ask questions to clarify conversations, directions, exercises, and/or classroom routines.
- Carry on and participate in a conversation over at least six turns, staying on topic, initiating comments or responding to a partner’s comments, with either an adult or another child of the same age.
- Identify and express physical sensations, mental states, and emotions of self and others.
- Understand and use language to express spatial and temporal relationships (*up, down, first, last, before, after, etc.*).
- Understand and use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions.
- Understand and use common sayings and phrases such as “Hit the nail on the head” and “Let the cat out of the bag.”

B. Presentation of Ideas and Information

- Follow multi-step, oral directions.
- Give simple directions.
- Provide simple explanations.
- Recite a nursery rhyme, poem or song independently, using appropriate eye contact, volume and clear enunciation.
- Give oral presentations about personal experiences, topics of interest, and/or stories, using appropriate eye contact, volume and clear enunciation.

C. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—All Texts

Teachers: Written text makes use of richer vocabulary and more complex syntax than conversational language. It is important that young children be exposed not only to the language of everyday conversation but also to the richer and more formal language of books.

This can be done through frequent reading aloud. Helping young children develop the ability to listen to and understand written texts read aloud must be an integral part of any initiative designed to build literacy.

At the first grade level, a students' abilities to understand what they hear far their abilities to independently read and understand written text. By listening to stories or nonfiction selections read aloud, students can experience the complexities of written language without expending cognitive energy on decoding; they can likewise access deeper and more complex content knowledge than they are presently able to read independently.

Careful consideration should be given to the selection of books read aloud to ensure that the vocabulary and syntax presented is rich and complex. Leveled texts will not provide the rich language experience desired during read-alouds and should only be used as a starting point with students for whom English is a second language.

Nonfiction read-alouds should be selected on the basis of the history, science, music and visual art topics identified for Grade 1 students in the *Core Knowledge Sequence*, with emphasis on history and science read-alouds. It is strongly recommended that daily read-alouds focus on a single topic over a sustained period of time—about two weeks—rather than intermingling read-alouds on a variety of subjects. Careful consideration should be given to the order in which nonfiction read-alouds are presented to ensure that knowledge about a topic builds in a progressive and coherent way.

Following any read-aloud, students should participate in rich, structured conversations with an adult in response to the written text that has been read aloud. In this way, they can begin to orally practice comparing, analyzing, and synthesizing ideas in written text in much the same way as they will be expected to do as independent readers in the later grades.

- Listen to and understand a variety of texts read aloud, including fictional stories, fairy tales, fables, historical narratives, drama, informational text, and poems.
- Distinguish the following genres of literature: fiction, nonfiction and drama.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Describe illustrations.
- Sequence four to six pictures illustrating events in a read-aloud.
- Answer questions requiring literal recall and understanding of the details and/or facts of a read-aloud, i.e., who, what, where, when, etc.
- Retell key details.
- Ask questions to clarify information in a read-aloud.
- Use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions, a scene or facts in a read-aloud.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Understand and use words and phrases heard in read-alouds.
- Compare and contrast similarities and differences within a single read-aloud or between two or more read-alouds.
- Make personal connections to events or experiences in a read-aloud and/or make connections among several read-alouds.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to listening to a read-aloud, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read aloud.
- Use pictures accompanying the read-aloud to check and support understanding of the read-aloud.
- Make predictions prior to and during a read-aloud, based on the title, pictures, and/or text heard thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.
- Answer questions that require making interpretations, judgments, or giving opinions about what is heard in a read-aloud, including answering "why" questions that require recognizing cause/effect relationships.

- Interpret information that is presented orally and then ask additional questions to clarify information or the topic in the read-aloud.
- Identify who is telling a story or providing information in a text.

D. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry

- Retell or dramatize a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence.
- Compare and contrast characters from different stories.
- Change some story events and provide a different story ending.
- Create and tell an original story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence.
- Distinguish fantasy from realistic text in a story.
- Identify the moral or lesson of a fable, folktale, or myth.
- Demonstrate understanding of literary language (e.g., author, illustrator, characters, setting, plot, dialogue, personification, simile, and metaphor) and use some of these terms in retelling stories or creating their own stories.
- Identify sensory language and how it is used to describe people, objects, places and events.

E. Comprehension and Discussion of Read-Alouds—Nonfiction and Informational Text

Teachers: Select nonfiction read-aloud topics from the first grade history, science, music, and visual arts topics, with emphasis on history and science.

- Generate questions and seek information from multiple sources to answer questions.
- Answer questions about the details of a nonfiction text, indicating which part of the text provided the information needed to answer specific questions.
- With assistance, categorize and organize facts and information within a given topic.
- With assistance, create and interpret timelines and lifelines related to read-alouds.
- Distinguish read-alouds that describe events that happened long ago from those that describe contemporary or current events.

II. Reading

A. Print Awareness

- Demonstrate understanding that what is said can be written and that the writing system is a way of writing down sounds.
- Demonstrate understanding of directionality (left to right, return sweep, top to bottom, front to back).
- Identify the parts of books and function of each part (front cover, back cover, title page, table of contents).
- Demonstrate correct book orientation by holding book correctly and turning pages.
- Recognize that sentences in print are made up of separate words.
- Understand that words are separated by spaces.
- Distinguish letters, words, sentences, and stories.
- Demonstrate understanding of basic print conventions by tracking and following print word for word when listening to text read aloud.
- Demonstrate understanding that the sequence of letters in a written word represents the sequence of sounds in the spoken word.
- Recognize and name the 26 letters of the alphabet in both their upper-case and lower-case forms.
- Say the letters of the alphabet in order, either in song or recitation.

B. Phonemic Awareness

- Demonstrate understanding that words are made up of sequences of sounds.
- Demonstrate understanding that vowel sounds are produced with the mouth open and airflow unobstructed, whereas consonant sounds involve closing parts of the mouth and blocking the air flow.
- Given a pair of spoken words, select the one that is longer (i.e., contains more phonemes).
- In riddle games, supply words that begin with a target phoneme.
- Indicate whether a target phoneme is or is not present in the initial/medial/final position of a spoken word, e.g., hear /m/ at the beginning of *mat* and /g/ at the end of *bag*.
- Listen to one-syllable words and tell the beginning or ending sounds, e.g., given *dog*, identify initial /d/ or final /g/.
- Recognize the same phoneme in different spoken words, e.g., /b/ in *ball*, *bug*, and *big*.
- Identify whether pairs of phonemes are the same or different, including pairs that differ only in voicing, e.g., /b/ and /p/.
- Orally blend two to three sounds to form a word, e.g., given the sounds /k/... /a/... /t/, blend to make *cat*.
- Segment a spoken word into phonemes, e.g., given *bat*, produce the segments/b//a//t/.
- Given a spoken word, produce another word that rhymes, e.g., given *hit*, supply *bit* or *mitt*.
- Identify the number of syllables in a spoken word.

C. Phonics: Decoding and Encoding

Teachers: Learning to read requires understanding and mastering the written English code through explicit and systematic phonics instruction. Research suggests that phonics instruction is most effective when specific letter-sound relationships are taught and reinforced by having students both read and write the letter-sound correspondence being studied. Reading and writing—decoding and encoding—are complementary processes that ensure mastery of the written code.

- Demonstrate understanding that a systematic, predictable relationship exists between written letters (graphemes) and spoken sounds (phonemes).
- Blend individual phonemes to pronounce printed words.
- Understand that sometimes two or more printed letters stand for a single sound.
- Read one to two syllable words containing any of the grapheme-phoneme correspondences listed below.
- Read and write words with inflectional endings, i.e., -s, -ed, -ing, -er, -est.
- Read, understand, and write contractions, i.e., *isn't*, *I'm*, *can't*, etc.
- Sort and classify words according to the spelling used to represent a specific phoneme.
- Read tricky spellings that can be sounded two ways, e.g., the letter 's' sounded /s/ as in *cats* and /z/ as in *dogs*.
- Read and spell chains of one-syllable words in which one sound is added, substituted, or omitted, i.e., read at > *cat* > *bat* > *bad* > *bid*.
- Read at least 30 words generally identified as high frequency words.

Consonant Sounds and Spellings Taught in First Grade

/b/ spelled 'b' as in *boy*, 'bb' as in *tubby*

/d/ spelled 'd' as in *dog*, 'dd' as in *madder*, 'ed' as in *filled*

/f/ spelled 'f' as in *fun*, 'ff' as in *stuff*

/g/ spelled 'g' as in *get*, 'gg' as in *egg*

/h/ spelled 'h' as in *him*

/j/ spelled 'j' as in *jump*, 'g' as in *gem*, 'ge' as in *fringe*

/k/ spelled 'c' as in *cat*, 'k' as in *kitten*, 'ck' as in *sick*, 'cc' as in *moccasin*

/l/ spelled 'l' as in *lip*, 'll' as in *sell*
 /m/ spelled 'm' as in *mad*, 'mm' as in *hammer*
 /n/ spelled 'n' as in *net*, 'nn' as in *funny*, 'kn' as in *knock*
 /p/ spelled 'p' as in *pet*, 'pp' as in *happy*
 /r/ spelled 'r' as in *red*, 'rr' as in *earring*, 'wr' as in *wrist*
 /s/ spelled 's' as in *sit*, 'ss' as in *dress*, 'c' as in *cent*, 'ce' as in *prince*, 'se' as in *rinse*
 /t/ spelled 't' as in *top*, 'tt' as in *butter*, 'ed' as in *asked*
 /v/ spelled 'v' as in *vet*, 've' as in *twelve*
 /w/ spelled 'w' as in *wet*, 'wh' as in *when*
 /x/ spelled 'x' as in *tax*
 /y/ spelled 'y' as in *yes*
 /z/ spelled 'z' as in *zip*, 'zz' as in *buzz*, 's' as in *dogs*
 /ch/ spelled 'ch' as in *chop*, 'tch' as in *itch*
 /sh/ spelled 'sh' as in *ship*
 /th/ spelled 'th' as in *thin*
 /th/ spelled 'th' as in *then*
 /qu/ spelled 'qu' as in *quick*
 /ng/ spelled 'ng' as in *sing*, 'n' as in *pink*

Vowel Sounds and Spellings Taught in First Grade

/a/ spelled 'a' as in *cat*
 /e/ spelled 'e' as in *get*
 /i/ spelled 'i' as in *hit*
 /o/ spelled 'o' as in *hot*
 /u/ spelled 'u' as in *but*
 /ae/ spelled 'a_e' as in *cake*, 'ai' as in *wait*, 'ay' as in *day*, 'a' as in *paper*
 /ee/ spelled 'ee' as in *bee*, 'e' as in *me*, 'y' as in *funny*, 'ea' as in *beach*, 'e_e' as in *Pete*, 'ie' as in *cookie*
 /ie/ spelled 'i_e' as in *bike*, 'i' as in *biting*, 'y' as in *try*, 'ie' as in *tie*, 'igh' as in *night*
 /oe/ spelled 'o_e' as in *note*, 'oa' as in *boat*, 'oe' as in *toe*, 'o' as in *open*, 'ow' as in *snow*
 /ue/ spelled 'u_e' as in *cute*
 /aw/ spelled 'aw' as in *paw*
 /oo/ spelled 'oo' as in *look*, /oo/ spelled 'oo' as in *soon*
 /ou/ spelled 'ou' as in *shout*
 /oi/ spelled 'oi' as in *oil*
 /er/ spelled 'er' as in *her*
 /ar/ spelled 'ar' as in *car*
 /or/ spelled 'or' as in *for*

D. Oral Reading and Fluency

- Read decodable stories that incorporate the specific code knowledge that has been taught.
- Demonstrate increased accuracy, fluency, and expression on successive reading of a decodable text (50 wpm by the end of the year).
- Use phonics skills in conjunction with context to confirm or self-correct word recognition and understanding, rereading as necessary.
- Demonstrate understanding of and use of commas and end punctuation while reading orally.
- Read aloud, alone, or with a partner at least 15 minutes each day.

E. Reading Comprehension—All Texts

Teachers: During the beginning of first grade, most students will still need to devote considerable energy when reading to deciphering the written text. Over the course of this year, they will learn even more elements of the code, meaning that the decodable texts that they can read independently will increasingly resemble “real stories” and trade books. With practice and repeated readings of the same text, students will develop increasing automaticity, allowing them to focus more intently on the meaning of what they are reading. Both of these factors, i.e., the student’s increasing fluency and the use of more authentic text—which is now decodable because of the student’s increasing code knowledge—mean that attention to reading comprehension can move to a higher level than just the rudimentary understanding of text expected at the kindergarten level. This expectation is reflected in the increased number of objectives below that have been added to the kindergarten level objectives. However, it is important to remember that listening comprehension still far exceeds reading comprehension and that children’s ability to talk about what they have heard and/or read will exceed their ability to demonstrate that understanding in writing.

- Demonstrate understanding of completely decodable text after reading independently.

Grasping Specific Details and Key Ideas

- Sequence four to six pictures illustrating events from a text that has been read independently.
- Answer questions requiring literal recall and understanding of the details and/or facts (i.e., who, what, where, when, etc.) about a text that has been read independently.
- Retell key details from a text that has been read independently.
- Ask questions to clarify information about a text that has been read independently.
- Use narrative language to describe people, places, things, locations, events, actions, a scene or facts from a text that has been read independently.

Observing Craft and Structure

- Identify basic text features and what they mean, including title, table of contents, and chapters.
- Understand and use words and phrases from a text that has been read independently.
- Compare and contrast similarities and differences within a single text or between multiple texts read independently.
- Make personal connections to events or experiences in a text that has been read independently and/or make connections among several texts that have been read independently.

Integrating Information and Evaluating Evidence

- Prior to reading, identify what they know and have learned that may be related to the specific story or topic to be read.
- Use pictures accompanying the written text to check and support understanding.
- Make predictions prior to and while reading, based on the title, pictures, and/or text read thus far and then compare the actual outcomes to predictions.
- Answer questions that require making interpretations, judgments, or giving opinions about what is read independently, including answering “why” questions that require recognizing cause/effect relationships.
- Identify who is telling a story or providing information in a text.
- Identify temporal words that link and sequence events, i.e., first, next, then, etc.
- Identify words that link ideas, i.e., *for example*, *also*, *in addition*.

F. Reading Comprehension—Fiction, Drama, and Poetry

- Retell or dramatize a story, using narrative language to describe characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence.
- Compare and contrast characters from different stories.

- Change some story events and provide a different story ending.
- Distinguish fantasy from realistic text in a story.
- Identify the moral or lesson of a fable, folktale, or myth.
- Demonstrate understanding of literary language (e.g., author, illustrator, characters, setting, plot, dialogue, personification, simile, and metaphor) and use some of these terms in retelling stories or creating their own stories.
- Identify sensory language and how it is used to describe people, objects, places and events.

G. Reading Comprehension—Nonfiction and Informational Text

Teachers: Select nonfiction topics from the first grade history, science, music and visual arts topics listed on pages 35–47, with emphasis on history and science.

- With assistance, create and interpret timelines and lifelines related to text read independently.
- Distinguish text that describes events that happened long ago from text that describes contemporary or current events.

III. Writing

Teachers: It is important to recognize that of all the communication skills—listening, speaking, reading, and writing—writing is the most demanding and challenging. During the beginning of first grade, students still need to devote much of their focus and cognitive energy to the code itself, as well as the fine motor act of writing. During this period, teachers should continue to support written expression through shared writing experiences that are modeled and scaffolded by an adult.

At some point during the first grade year, however, most students will feel comfortable enough with the basic skills to begin making a transition to writing more independently. Young children's desire to express themselves in writing should be heartily encouraged. To this end, it is important that teachers have age-appropriate expectations about what first grade student writing should resemble. Students have not been taught all of the spellings they will need to achieve dictionary-correct spelling. It is therefore premature to expect that words in their independent writing will be spelled correctly. It is reasonable to expect students to use the letter-sound correspondences they have learned to set down plausible spellings for the sounds in the word. For example, a student who writes *bote* for *boat*, *dun* for *done*, or *hed* for *head* has set down a plausible spelling for each sound in the word, using the code knowledge taught in this grade. This should be seen as good spelling for this stage of literacy acquisition. Dictionary-correct spelling will be a realistic goal when students have learned more spellings and learned how to use a dictionary to check spelling.

Furthermore, while teachers can begin to model and scaffold the use of a writing process, such as "Plan-Draft-Edit," it is equally important not to dampen student enthusiasm by rigidly insisting that all student writing be edited over and over again to bring the text to the "publication" stage. A sensible balance that encourages children to use their current skill knowledge when writing—without stifling creative expression—is optimal at the first grade level.

Writing to Reflect Audience, Purpose and Task

- Add details to writing
- Begin to use tools, including technology, to plan, draft, and edit writing

Conducting Research

- Gather information from experiences or provided text sources.

A. Narrative Writing

- Write or retell a story that includes characters, setting(s), and a beginning, a middle and an end to events of the story in proper sequence.
- Write a descriptive paragraph using sensory language.
- Create a title and an ending that are relevant to the narrative.

B. Informative/Explanatory Writing

- Write about a topic, including a beginning and ending sentence, facts and examples relevant to the topic, and specific steps (if writing explanatory text).

C. Persuasive Writing (Opinion)

- Express an opinion or point of view in writing, providing reasons and supporting details for preference or opinion using the linking word *because*.
- Create a title that is relevant to the topic or subject of the text.
- If writing about a specific book or read-aloud, refer to the content of the text.

IV. Language Conventions

- Form letters, words, phrases and sentences to communicate thoughts and ideas.
- Apply basic spelling conventions.
- Use basic capitalization and punctuation in sentences to convey meaning.

A. Handwriting and Spelling

- Print from memory the twenty-six letters of the alphabet accurately in both their upper-case and lower-case forms.
- Write on primary lined paper from left to right, staying within the lines and leaving spaces between words, and from top to bottom, using return sweep.
- Write phonemically plausible spellings for words that cannot be spelled correctly with current code knowledge, e.g., write *ate* for *eight*, *boi* for *boy*, *fone* for *phone*.
- Write words, phrases, and sentences from dictation, applying phonics knowledge.
- Identify and use synonyms and antonyms.

B. Parts of Speech and Sentence Structure

- Recognize, identify and use subject, object, and possessive pronouns, i.e., *I*, *me*, *my*, *they*, *them*, orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use common and proper nouns, orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify and use regular verbs to convey a sense of past, present, and future tense orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use adjectives orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use subjects and predicates, orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Recognize, identify, and use statements, questions, and exclamations orally, in written text, and in own writing.
- Produce and expand complete sentences orally and in shared writing exercises.

C. Capitalization and Punctuation

- Capitalize the first word in a sentence, the pronoun *I*, and proper nouns (names and places,) months, days of the week.
- Identify and use end punctuation, including periods, question marks, and exclamation points.
- Use commas appropriately in greetings and closings of letters, dates, and items in a series.
- Write a simple friendly letter.
- Use apostrophes to create contractions and indicate possession, i.e., cat's meow.
- Use quotation marks appropriately to designate direct speech.

Note: The poems listed here constitute a selected core of poetry for this grade. You are encouraged to expose children to more poetry, old and new, and to have students write their own poems. To bring students into the spirit of poetry, read it aloud and encourage them to speak it aloud so they can experience the music in the words. Although students are not expected to memorize the following rhymes, they will delight in knowing their favorites by heart, and will experience a sense of achievement and satisfaction in being able to recite some of the rhymes.

V. Poetry

"Hope" (Langston Hughes)
 "I Know All the Sounds the Animals Make" (Jack Prelutsky)
 "My Shadow" (Robert Louis Stevenson)
 "The Owl and the Pussycat" (Edward Lear)
 "The Pasture" (Robert Frost)
 "The Purple Cow" (Gelett Burgess)
 "Rope Rhyme" (Eloise Greenfield)
 "Sing a Song of People" (Lois Lenski)
 "Solomon Grundy" (traditional)
 "The Swing" (Robert Louis Stevenson)
 "Table Manners" [also known as "The Goops"] (Gelett Burgess)
 "Thanksgiving Day" ["Over the river and through the wood"] (Lydia Maria Child)
 "Washington" (Nancy Byrd Turner)
 "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod" (Eugene Field)

VI. Fiction

Teachers: While the following works make up a strong core of literature, the content of language arts includes not only stories, fables, and poems, but also the well-practiced, operational knowledge of how written symbols represent sounds, and how those sounds and symbols convey meaning. Thus, the stories specified below are meant to complement, not to replace, materials designed to help students practice decoding and encoding skills (see above, II. Reading and III. Writing).

The titles here constitute a core of stories for this grade. They are available in a variety of editions, some designed for novice readers, and others best for reading aloud to children. In first grade, most of the following titles should be read-aloud selections. It is recommended that you provide a mixture of texts, including some beginning readers, with their necessarily limited vocabulary and syntax, for these can give children the important sense of accomplishment that comes from being able to "read it all by myself."

Expose students to many more stories, including classic picture books and read-aloud books. (In schools, teachers across grade levels should communicate their choices in order to avoid undue repetition.) Students should also be exposed to nonfiction prose—biographies, books on science and history, books on art and music—and they should be given opportunities to tell and write their own stories.

A. Stories

"The Boy at the Dike" (folktale from Holland)
 "The Frog Prince"
 "Hansel and Gretel"
 selections from *The House at Pooh Corner* (A. A. Milne)
 "How Anansi Got Stories from the Sky God" (folktale from West Africa)
 "It Could Always Be Worse" (Yiddish folktale)
 "Jack and the Beanstalk"
 "The Knee-High Man" (African-American folktale)
 "Medio Pollito" (Hispanic folktale)
 "The Pied Piper of Hamelin"
 "Pinocchio"
 "The Princess and the Pea"
 "Puss-in-Boots"
 "Rapunzel"
 "Rumpelstiltskin"
 "Sleeping Beauty"
The Tale of Peter Rabbit (Beatrix Potter)

Tales of Br'er Rabbit (recommended tales: "Br'er Rabbit Gets Br'er Fox's Dinner," "Br'er Rabbit Tricks Br'er Bear," "Br'er Rabbit and the Tar Baby")
"Why the Owl Has Big Eyes" (Native American legend)

B. Aesop's Fables

"The Boy Who Cried Wolf"
"The Dog in the Manger"
"The Wolf in Sheep's Clothing"
"The Maid and the Milk Pail"
"The Fox and the Grapes"
"The Goose and the Golden Eggs"

C. Different Lands, Similar Stories

Teachers: To give students a sense that people all around the world tell certain stories that, while they differ in details, have much in common, introduce students to similar folktales from different lands, such as the following:

"Lon Po Po" (China) and Little Red Riding Hood
"Issun Boshi", or "One-Inch Boy" (Japan)
"Tom Thumb" (England)
"Thumbelina" (by the Danish writer Hans Christian Andersen)
"Little Finger of the Watermelon Patch" (Vietnam)
Some of the many variations on the Cinderella story (from Europe, Africa, China, Vietnam, Egypt, Korea, etc.)

D. Literary Terms

- Characters, heroes, and heroines
- Drama
 - actors and actresses
 - costumes, scenery and props
 - theater, stage, audience

E. Sayings and Phrases

Teachers: Every culture has phrases and proverbs that make no sense when carried over literally into another culture. For many students, this section may not be needed; they will have picked up these sayings by hearing them at home and among friends. But the sayings have been one of the categories most appreciated by teachers who work with students from home cultures that differ from the standard culture of literate American English.

a.m. and p.m.

An apple a day keeps the doctor away.

Do unto others as you would have them do unto you. [also in Kindergarten]

Fish out of water

Hit the nail on the head.

If at first you don't succeed, try, try again.

Land of Nod

Let the cat out of the bag.

The more the merrier

Never leave till tomorrow what you can do today.

Practice makes perfect. [also in Kindergarten]

Sour grapes

There's no place like home.

Wolf in sheep's clothing

Note: Students should learn terms relating to drama as part of their participation in a play appropriate for first graders—possibly a dramatized version of one of the stories listed above.